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## Global Energy Storage

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# Battery Weekly 19 October

### North America

GM Taps South Korean Suppliers for LMR Battery Production - The Elec. GM is tapping South Korean suppliers for components, materials and equipment for its next-generation prismatic LMR batteries, which are being jointly developed with LG Energy Solution. GM targets ~33% higher energy density than LFP at similar costs and plans to begin mass production at the Ultium Cells Spring Hill, Tennessee plant in 2028, initially targeting mainstream electric pickups with more than 400 miles of range.

LG Energy Solution Reworks ESS Equipment Supplier Base - The Elec. LG Energy Solution is restructuring its ESS equipment supplier base after key supplier Daejin Machinery defaulted, shifting more orders to suppliers including SYSTEM R&D and HyVISION SYSTEM while seeking additional partners. The changes support LGES's expanding North American ESS manufacturing footprint, including module production in Ohio.

Mercedes-Backed Factorial Energy Partners With Korean Battery Equipment Suppliers - The Elec. US solid-state battery developer Factorial Energy is expanding its pilot production line in Cheonan, South Korea, selecting PNT for dry-electrode equipment and Philenergy for cell-assembly systems. The line will validate manufacturing processes and yields ahead of Factorial's planned future mass-production line in Boston, while supporting commercialization of its lithium-metal solid-state battery technology.

Trafigura secures access to lithium from EnergyX - electrive. Trafigura has signed a 10-year agreement for 100,000 tonnes of battery-grade lithium products from EnergyX's projects in Texas and Chile, in a deal valued at more than US$2 billion at current prices. A significant share is intended for US battery production, supporting more localized lithium supply for the American EV and ESS industries.

Rivian Is Taking Its Battery Recycling Game To The Next Level - InsideEVs. Rivian is expanding its partnership with Redwood Materials to recycle battery manufacturing scrap and end-of-life EV batteries, while suitable used packs will be repurposed for stationary energy storage. Redwood is already deploying 10 MWh of second-life storage at Rivian's Normal, Illinois plant and says its recycling process can recover more than 95% of critical minerals including lithium, nickel, cobalt and copper.

### Asia

Chinese Lithium Slumps 10% After EU Deal Slashes Hybrid Exports - BNEF. Chinese lithium futures fell 10% to RMB104,740/tonne after an EU-China agreement to restrict Chinese hybrid vehicle exports weakened battery-material demand expectations. The decline adds to pressure from softer expected EV and ESS growth, with Goldman Sachs expecting the lithium market to move toward balance in 4Q26 and into surplus over the following two years.

Changan and CATL to expand battery capacity to 75 GWh - electrive. Changan and CATL plan to expand their joint battery manufacturing capacity from 50 GWh to 75 GWh, with an additional 25 GWh facility expected to begin operations in 2027. The partnership will also deepen cooperation on solid-state and sodium-ion batteries, supporting Changan's Avatr, Deepal and Nevo EV brands.

BMW launches sixth-gen battery production in Shenyang - elective. BMW has started series production of its Gen6 high-voltage batteries in Shenyang, its third Gen6 battery facility globally, supporting locally produced Neue Klasse EVs in China. The new large cylindrical cells

deliver >20% higher energy density and up to 30% improvements in charging speed and range, while adopting a cell-to-pack architecture.

GBT begins series production of solid-state battery cells - electrive. China's Greater Bay Technology (GBT) has started series production of all-solid-state battery cells in Guangzhou on a converted lithium-ion line with initial capacity of 1 GWh, expandable to 4 GWh. Its technology targets 260–480 Wh/kg depending on cell generation and uses an organic-inorganic composite electrolyte designed to enable solid-state production on largely conventional lithium-ion equipment.

Seres commits Aito to CATL batteries long-term - electrive. Seres has extended its long-term battery partnership with CATL, keeping CATL batteries across the entire Aito model range. CATL will add another 10–12 GWh of battery production capacity at the Seres Super Factory in Chongqing, taking total capacity to more than 20 GWh, while cooperation will expand into charging, battery services and overseas markets.

Standard Energy Urges Lawmakers to Expand ESS Demonstration Projects - The Elec. South Korea's Standard Energy is calling for expanded demonstration projects and manufacturing support for non-lithium ESS technologies, particularly its vanadium-ion batteries. The company argues that increased testing opportunities and production support could accelerate commercialization of alternative storage technologies in a Korean ESS market currently dominated by lithium-ion batteries.

Eco&Dream Raises 35 Billion Won for Battery Materials - The Elec. Eco&Dream has raised KRW35 billion to fund raw-material purchases as it targets record precursor shipments in 2027. The company is also expanding into next-generation materials for LFP, LMR and all-solid-state batteries, including sulfide solid electrolytes and lithium sulfide.

Nio completes nearly 1.2 million battery swaps over 7-day holiday, sets daily record twice - CnEVPost. Nio completed 1.19 million battery swaps during China's seven-day National Day holiday, with average daily swaps up 22% YoY and a new daily record of 183,664 swaps. Nio currently operates 4,168 swap stations, including 1,073 highway locations, highlighting increasing utilization of its battery-swapping network.

### Europe

Europe's $40 Billion Battery Bet Set for Big Winter Payout - BNEF. Europe's battery storage fleet is positioned for a potentially strong winter as increasing gas prices and variable renewable generation widen intraday electricity-price spreads. Europe has invested around US $40 billion in batteries since the 2022 energy crisis, while UK battery revenues are increasingly shifting toward wholesale trading, which accounted for roughly 73% of sector revenue in the 12 months through August.

Fraunhofer stabilises aluminium anodes for lithium-ion batteries - electrive. Fraunhofer IPA and the University of Stuttgart have developed a new aluminium-anode architecture designed to control volume expansion during cycling. The technology eliminates graphite, silicon and the conventional copper current collector, potentially lowering material and manufacturing costs while remaining compatible with existing battery production infrastructure.

ProLogium and Rimac target 2028 for solid-state battery vehicle tests - electrive. ProLogium and Rimac Technology are developing a cell-to-pack architecture for solid-state pouch cells, targeting a functional battery segment in 2027, a full pack in 2H27 and on-road vehicle testing in 2H28. ProLogium will supply cell technology while Rimac handles battery-system integration, thermal management and pack architecture.

ACC announces five million battery cells 'Made in France' - electrive. Automotive Cells Company (ACC) has produced its five-millionth battery cell at its Douvrin factory in France, enough cumulative output for nearly 40,000 vehicles. A second 12.9 GWh production block is planned to start in 2027, taking total capacity to nearly 26 GWh, with the longer-term site target at around 40 GWh.

Cell bypass aims to extend the usable life of EV batteries - electrive. Researchers at Chalmers University of Technology have studied reconfigurable battery packs capable of bypassing weaker individual cells, potentially extending EV battery life by more than 20% under optimal conditions. The approach could also improve residual values and second-life usability, although it remains at the research and prototype stage. [electrive.com]

Peugeot Revives The RCZ As A Sexy Solid-State Sports Car - InsideEVs. Peugeot has unveiled the RCZ Vision, an electric sports-car concept featuring a Factorial-developed solid-state battery and 1,000V architecture. Peugeot claims up to 600 km of range and 10–80% charging in 10 minutes, although the RCZ Vision remains a concept without confirmed series-production plans.

## OTHERS

'Major' OEM to test Gelion's NES cathode platform - elective British-Australian battery developer Gelion has signed an agreement with an unnamed top-15 global automaker to evaluate its Nano Encapsulated Sulfur (NES) cathode technology in multiple configurations, including

liquid and solid electrolytes and lithium-metal and graphite anodes. The technology aims to reduce reliance on critical raw materials and potentially integrate with existing battery production lines, although the program remains at the evaluation stage.

EXHIBIT 1: **Key commodities price performance**

| | Price 16-Oct | Ccy | Mkt cap $bn | P/E 26E | EV /EBITDA 26E | %1D | %1W | %1M | %1Y | 1Y px chart |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Metal prices (US$/tonne)** | | | | | | | | | | |
| LiCO (spot) | 15,922 | | | | | -2.7% | -15% | -21% | 56% | |
| LiOH (spot) | 14,502 | | | | | -2.5% | -16% | -22% | 40% | |
| LiCO (contract) | 18,630 | | | | | 0.0% | -1% | 3% | 96% | |
| LiOH (contract) | 16,950 | | | | | 0.0% | -8% | -8% | 87% | |
| Cobalt (spot) | 36,380 | | | | | -6.5% | -6% | -10% | -14% | |
| Nickel (spot) | 15,221 | | | | | -1.9% | -3% | -5% | 0% | |
| **Component prices** | | | | | | | | | | |
| Cathode NMC811 | | | | | | -0.9% | -7% | -11% | 5% | |
| Cathode LFP | | | | | | -1.1% | -10% | -15% | 25% | |
| Precursor NMC811 | | | | | | -0.8% | -2% | -5% | -10% | |
| Precursor LFP | | | | | | 0.0% | 1% | 2% | 55% | |
| Artificial Graphite | | | | | | 0.0% | 0% | 0% | 6% | |
| Natural Graphite | | | | | | 0.0% | 0% | 0% | 0% | |
| Electrolyte NMC | | | | | | 0.0% | 0% | 2% | 35% | |
| Electrolyte LFP | | | | | | 0.0% | 0% | 2% | 50% | |
| Separator | | | | | | 0.0% | 0% | 0% | 28% | |
| **Spot battery cell cost (US$/kWh)** | | | | | | | | | | |
| LFP | 57 | | | | | -0.2% | -2% | -3% | 9% | |
| NMC532 | 76 | | | | | -0.5% | -3% | -6% | 3% | |
| NMC622 | 72 | | | | | -0.5% | -4% | -6% | 0% | |
| NMC811 | 76 | | | | | -0.4% | -3% | -6% | 4% | |
| **Spot battery pack cost (US$/kWh)** | | | | | | | | | | |
| LFP | 70 | | | | | -0.2% | -1% | -3% | -9% | |
| NMC532 | 107 | | | | | -0.4% | -2% | -5% | 2% | |
| NMC622 | 105 | | | | | -0.4% | -2% | -5% | 0% | |
| NMC811 | 108 | | | | | -0.3% | -2% | -4% | 3% | |

Source: Bloomberg, Baiinfo, Bernstein analysis and estimates (cell and pack cost)

## EXHIBIT 2: **Key companies price performance and valuation**

| | Price 16-Oct | Ccy | Mkt cap $bn | P/E 26E | EV /EBITDA 26E | %1D | %1W | %1M | %1Y | 1Y px chart |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Cell makers** | | | | | | | | | | |
| LGES | 403,000 | KRW | 70.8 | n.a. | 16.8x | 0.1% | 0% | 10% | -3% | |
| Samsung SDI | 530,000 | KRW | 32.1 | 71.9x | 15.9x | -1.9% | -7% | -3% | 122% | |
| CATL | 275.2 | CNY | 193.4 | 13.3x | 9.2x | -1.2% | -8% | -13% | -25% | |
| CALB | 15.4 | HKD | 3.5 | 8.8x | 2.1x | 0.6% | -4% | -6% | -52% | |
| EVE Energy | 46.8 | CNY | 15.2 | 13.9x | 8.8x | -0.4% | -9% | -3% | -44% | |
| Gotion | 27.7 | CNY | 7.5 | 25.3x | 6.1x | -1.8% | -9% | 9% | -34% | |
| Sunwoda | 18.2 | CNY | 5.0 | 16.8x | 5.4x | -1.4% | -12% | 2% | -41% | |
| Farasis | 9.0 | CNY | 1.6 | n.a. | n.a. | -1.0% | -8% | 1% | -49% | |
| **Lithium Miners/Refiners** | | | | | | | | | | |
| Albemarle | 98.2 | USD | 11.6 | 8.6x | 4.2x | 0.2% | -3% | -13% | 3% | |
| SQM | 60.5 | USD | 17.1 | 8.3x | 4.0x | -1.9% | -5% | -13% | 36% | |
| Pilbara Minerals | 3.0 | AUD | 6.7 | 16.4x | 8.1x | 0.3% | -15% | -30% | 12% | |
| Ganfeng Lithium | 23.8 | HKD | 10.8 | 5.6x | 5.9x | -7.0% | -21% | -28% | -48% | |
| Tianqi Lithium | 36.3 | CNY | 8.7 | 8.8x | 3.2x | -1.5% | -12% | -14% | -24% | |
| **Cathode** | | | | | | | | | | |
| LG Chem | 254,000 | KRW | 13.5 | n.a. | 2.4x | 0.8% | -11% | -6% | -19% | |
| EcoPro BM | 106,900 | KRW | 8.1 | 498.7x | 53.5x | 0.9% | -17% | 0% | -24% | |
| L&F | 93,700 | KRW | 2.9 | n.a. | 13.3x | -10.5% | -19% | -18% | -5% | |
| Umicore | 20.6 | EUR | 5.7 | 11.1x | 4.9x | -0.6% | -2% | -5% | 21% | |
| Ningbo Ronbay | 21.1 | CNY | 2.2 | 39.0x | 10.2x | -1.9% | -14% | -11% | -25% | |
| Beijing Easpring | 37.4 | CNY | 3.0 | 18.2x | 11.7x | -2.1% | -11% | -2% | -44% | |
| GEM | 5.9 | CNY | 4.5 | 15.8x | 4.9x | -2.6% | -6% | -5% | -31% | |
| Huayou Cobalt | 32.1 | CNY | 9.1 | 8.6x | 3.5x | -0.2% | -10% | -9% | -50% | |
| Dynanonic | 36.2 | CNY | 1.5 | 12.1x | 4.8x | -2.8% | -21% | -12% | -13% | |
| **Anode** | | | | | | | | | | |
| Posco | 171,600 | KRW | 11.5 | 513.9x | 47.1x | -0.8% | -11% | -9% | -10% | |
| Putailai | 19.4 | CNY | 6.2 | 12.8x | 7.9x | -1.4% | -13% | -13% | -28% | |
| Shanshan | 10.6 | CNY | 3.6 | n.a. | n.a. | -1.5% | -11% | -5% | -19% | |
| **Separator** | | | | | | | | | | |
| Asahi Kasei | 1,603 | JPY | 13.9 | 14.8x | 5.4x | 2.3% | 1% | 2% | 35% | |
| SK IE | 17,480 | KRW | 1.1 | n.a. | -21.9x | -1.6% | -6% | 6% | -44% | |
| Toray Industries | 1,246 | JPY | 11.9 | 23.2x | 7.2x | 2.0% | 1% | 2% | 35% | |
| W-Scope | 142 | JPY | 0.1 | n.a. | n.a. | 1.4% | -4% | 2% | -37% | |
| Yunnan Energy | 46.0 | CNY | 6.7 | 19.5x | 7.8x | -4.9% | -4% | -4% | 8% | |
| Shenzhen Senior | 14.0 | CNY | 2.9 | 28.5x | 9.0x | -2.1% | -11% | -10% | 4% | |
| Sinoma Science | 42.5 | CNY | 10.7 | 23.6x | 9.9x | 0.0% | -18% | -21% | 40% | |
| **Electrolyte** | | | | | | | | | | |
| Enchem | 19,690 | KRW | 0.3 | n.a. | n.a. | -0.1% | -11% | -4% | -76% | |
| Tinci Minerals | 28.6 | CNY | 8.7 | 9.2x | 6.6x | -2.9% | -20% | -13% | -19% | |
| Capchem | 55.1 | CNY | 6.2 | 18.7x | 13.8x | -2.1% | -15% | -24% | 20% | |
| Jiangsu Guotai | 7.4 | CNY | 1.8 | 9.4x | n.a. | -0.4% | -4% | -4% | -15% | |
| Shanshan | 10.6 | CNY | 3.6 | n.a. | n.a. | -1.5% | -11% | -5% | -19% | |
| **Equipment Maker** | | | | | | | | | | |
| Hirano | 1,692 | JPY | 0.2 | 16.0x | n.a. | 1.4% | -4% | -6% | 4% | |
| CKD | 5,030 | JPY | 2.2 | 27.0x | 14.1x | 1.4% | -14% | 1% | 53% | |
| Wuxi Lead | 31.0 | CNY | 7.5 | 21.1x | 16.5x | -4.3% | -16% | -2% | -44% | |
| Shenzhen Yinghe | 18.9 | CNY | 1.8 | 18.3x | 11.0x | -4.4% | -17% | -10% | -39% | |
| Zhejiang HangKe | 17.3 | CNY | 1.6 | 19.6x | 16.1x | 0.6% | -16% | -15% | -47% | |
| Guangdong Lyric | 43.0 | CNY | 1.1 | 46.5x | 19.0x | 4.0% | 2% | 29% | -29% | |
| Shenzhen United | 17.0 | CNY | 0.9 | 17.3x | 10.6x | 0.4% | -12% | -17% | -27% | |

Source: Bloomberg (all estimates), Bernstein analysis

### Company Models

CATL | LG Energy Solution | Samsung SDI

LG Chem | EcoPro BM | Posco Future M

Tianqi Lithium

Sungrow

### Industry Models

Model: ESS tracker

Model: Monthly EV Tracker

Model: Battery Gigafactory Database

Industry model: Global EV TAM

Industry model: Global ESS TAM

Industry model: Battery TAM

Industry model: Battery supply and demand

### Blackbook

Battery Utopia

Battery Tech Roadmap 2023: Faster, Higher, Stronger

Turn Up the Voltage... Investing Across the Battery Value Chain

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### Recent Research

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Global Energy Storage: More downside risks ahead for Korean cathode makers

CATL: Does CATL deserve a premium or discount for HK IPO?

CATL: Initial perspectives on HK IPO Plans

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## BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

| | | | 16 Oct 2026 | | TTM | Reported EPS | | | | Reported P/E (x) | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | Closing | Price | Rel. | | | | | | | |
| Ticker | Rating | Cur | Price | Target | Perf. | Cur | 2025A | 2026E | 2027E | 2025A | 2026E | 2027E |
| 300750.CH (CATL) | O | CNY | 277.00 | 770.00 | (39.2)% | CNY | 16.14 | 21.10 | 26.28 | 17.2 | 13.1 | 10.5 |
| 3750.HK (CATL) | O | HKD | 441.00 | 740.00 | (32.1)% | CNY | 16.14 | 21.10 | 26.28 | 23.3 | 17.8 | 14.3 |
| 051910.KS (LG Chem) | M | KRW | 252,000 | 312,000 | (33.8)% | KRW | (13,258.70) | 2,693.22 | 28,743 | (19.0) | 93.6 | 8.8 |
| 373220.KS (LGES) | M | KRW | 402,500 | 351,000 | (18.6)% | KRW | (4,580.94) | (2,364.33) | 10,225 | (87.9) | (170.2) | 39.4 |
| 006400.KS (SDI) | M | KRW | 540,000 | 520,000 | 107.1% | KRW | (9,933.80) | 1,751.66 | 18,577 | (54.4) | 308.3 | 29.1 |
| 247540.KS (EcoPro BM) | U | KRW | 105,900 | 140,000 | (39.2)% | KRW | 403.00 | 854.00 | 1,963.00 | 262.8 | 124.0 | 53.9 |
| 300274.CH (Sungrow) | O | RMB | 76.86 | 151.00 | (68.0)% | RMB | 6.55 | 6.93 | 7.95 | 11.7 | 11.1 | 9.7 |
| 002466.CH (Tianqi Lithium) | O | CNY | 36.44 | 80.00 | (38.4)% | CNY | 0.28 | 3.90 | 7.75 | 129.1 | 9.3 | 4.7 |
| 9696.HK (Tianqi Lithium) | O | HKD | 23.86 | 65.00 | (61.4)% | CNY | 0.28 | 3.90 | 7.75 | 72.0 | 5.2 | 2.6 |
| ASIAX | | | 1,831.65 | | | | | | | | | |

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

## I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

References to "Bernstein" or the "Firm" in these disclosures relate to the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC (pre April 1, 2024), Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A. (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK（サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社）and analysts employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services to produce Bernstein research under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

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The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

- Outperform: Stock will outpace the market index by more than 15 pp
- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/-15 pp
- Underperform: Stock will trail the performance of the market index by more than 15 pp

Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Bernstein research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

#### Autonomous brand – common stocks

The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

The Autonomous brand has three categories of common stock ratings:

- Outperform (OP): Stock will outpace the relevant index by more than 10 pp
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